ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** realistic	Realism.
2	**(b)** to deal well with a challenge	Idiom.
3	**(d)** Mother asked if I would try again.	Question.
4	**(d)** encouraging yet cautious	Balanced.
5	**(a)** sender's address, date, salutation, body, closing	Format.
6	**(a)** should	Advice.
7	**(d)** action and persistence	Action.
8	**(c)** when we try difficult things	Growth.
9	**(d)** Dreams are built by effort.	Are built.
10	**(c)** a shared effort	Shared.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	She urges Ming to follow her dream (1) yet lists effort and sacrifice she must expect (1).	1+1
12	A letter allows careful thought (1) and can be kept and re-read (1).	1+1
13	Commands sound urgent (1) and speak directly to the reader (1).	1+1
14	No one achieves alone (1) and others give help and comfort in setbacks (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Dreams need time (1). They may need giving up comforts (1). Sacrifice shows seriousness (1).	1+1+1
16	She knows the cost of effort (1). She has seen dreams change (1). Her advice carries authority (1).	1+1+1
17	If you work hard, you will succeed (1). Imperative becomes an if clause (1). First conditional (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She lists costs (1). She mentions the need for help (1). She speaks of possible changes (1).	1+1+1
18	Mastery takes time (1). Patience is needed (1). Time tests commitment (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Ming should plan because dreams take time (1). 'Because' gives a reason (1). It makes a complex sentence (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Optimism in the call to follow dreams (1). Realism in cost and effort (1). Support network (1). Flexibility (1). Balanced message (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme (1). Devices (1). Language (1). Mood (1). Personal response (1).	2+2+1
20	Follow your dream (1). Count the cost (1). Work and sacrifice (1). Seek support (1). Your choice and reason (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Letter: planning and support (1). Poem: courage to start (1). Both stress belief (1). Together they cover mind and action (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling 'Follow That Dream' a diary or speech. It is a **letter from a mother to her daughter Ming**, so answers should say 'the mother advises'.
- Reducing the message to 'wish for it and it will come'. The letter says dreams are built through sustained effort, not luck or wishful thinking (hoping without acting).
- Forgetting the support network. The mother stresses that no one succeeds alone; family and friends help. A 'sacrifice' means giving up something for a goal, not a prize.
- Ignoring the fear of starting: beginning is hard because of the fear of failure, but a start must be made; self-belief gives courage to continue after setbacks.

- In the poem, calling 'comfort is a warm room' a simile. It is a **metaphor**; the theme is self-belief and perseverance, and the mood is encouraging.
- Usage slips: *Believe **in** yourself*, *She **has followed** her dream for years*, and *a* dream (consonant sound), not 'an dream'.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** phrasal verb meaning to take action	Phrasal verb.
2	**(a)** the ability to recover	Bounce back.
3	**(a)** wishing without acting	Passive.
4	**(d)** a guide that keeps one on track	Self-belief.
5	**(a)** Following a dream is the best choice in life.	Opinion.
6	**(d)** never tried	Regret of inaction.
7	**(c)** it urges and motivates	Command.
8	**(a)** don't they	Positive-negative tag.
9	**(c)** flexibility is wise	Adaptability.
10	**(c)** steady and driving	Motivational.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Warm tone shows care (1) so advice is easy to accept (1).	1+1
12	It should not stop us (1) because trying is how we grow (1).	1+1
13	Wishing is passive (1) while striving involves planned action (1).	1+1
14	Comfort is set against challenge (1) so the choice to grow is clear (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Some never act (1). Some give up (1). Circumstances can change (1).	1+1+1
16	A challenge is like a mountain or a closed door (1). It makes difficulty visible (1). It prepares for effort (1).	1+1+1
17	Ming took the plunge and began (1). She stayed the course through difficulties (1). They mean start boldly and persist (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Opens with encouragement (1). Middle lists conditions (1). Ends with support (1).	1+1+1
18	No one may be watching (1). Courage is private (1). Self-belief must be internal (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Name the person (1). Both faced obstacles (1). Both used effort and belief (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Warm address (1). Logical points (1). Examples of effort (1). Honest cautions (1). Positive close (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Letter's idea (1). Poem's idea (1). Examples (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Meaning (1). Examples (1). Role of effort (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening (1). The fear (1). The first step (1). The challenge (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** difficult	Difficult.
2	**(a)** she is capable of serious effort	Trust.
3	**(d)** challenges are often faced alone	Solitude.
4	**(c)** despite great difficulty	Idiom.
5	**(c)** supportive	Supportive.
6	**(c)** comfort vs challenge	Comfort/challenge.
7	**(d)** Every journey begins with a single step	Caption.
8	**(c)** has a strong desire to succeed	Ambitious.
9	**(b)** She has been working towards her dream.	Has been working.
10	**(c)** Despite the difficulty, she continued.	Correct.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Effort needs belief to continue (1) and belief grows with effort (1).	1+1
12	It shows adapting to reality (1) without giving up on growth (1).	1+1
13	Starting needs courage over fear (1) while later steps follow momentum (1).	1+1
14	Plan and work steadily (1) and believe in one's ability (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The advice is general (1). The tone is warm (1). Anyone with a dream can relate (1).	1+1+1
16	They sound firm (1). They feel urgent (1). They are easy to remember (1).	1+1+1
17	Join a new club (1). Speak in public (1). Learn a new skill (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Talent gives a start (1). Effort and sacrifice complete it (1). The letter stresses both (1).	1+1+1
18	Mother told Ming that she believed in her (1). Present becomes past (1). Pronouns change (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The letter ends with support (1). The poem ends with belief (1). Both promise reward for effort (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Format (1). Thanks (1). The dream (1). The plan (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). The event (1). Feelings (1). The lesson (1). A new plan (1).	2+2+1
20	Theme (1). Metaphor of comfort (1). Imperatives (1). Tone (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Talent is the start (1). Effort turns it into skill (1). Support sustains (1). All three interact (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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